

Indicators of Compromise

Estimated time needed: 5 minutes

Introduction

An indicator of compromise (IOC) is evidence indicating that a system or network may have been compromised.

IOCs can include suspicious network traffic, malicious files, unusual system behavior, abnormal log entries, suspicious email messages or URLs, and unrecognized user accounts.

Suspicious network traffic

- Unexpected traffic spikes
- Unusual data packets
- Communication with suspicious IP addresses, often at irregular hours

Unusual system behavior

- Systems running slower than usual
- Frequent system crashes
- Error messages

Abnormal log entries

- Repeated login attempts
- Logins from unexpected locations

Phishing & social engineering

- Unrecognized email messages
- Suspicious URLs

Unrecognized user accounts

- Attacker-created accounts
- Outdated accounts

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